



FIREFLY

MEDIA LIBRARY

User Guide

Steam Deck Edition

Local media frontend for Steam Deck

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1 — Overview

Firefly Media Library is a local media frontend designed for the Steam Deck. It gives you a Netflix-style interface to browse and play your own Movies, TV Shows, and Videos entirely from local storage — no internet subscription required.

- **Movies** Poster grid with genre filtering and detail view
- **TV Shows** Season and episode browser with artwork support
- **Videos** Folder-based library for home videos, concerts, recordings
- **Genres** Browse all content by genre in scrollable rows
- **Collections** Auto-grouped from folder names (e.g. "Marvel Collection")
- **Search** Search across all libraries simultaneously
- **VLC Playback** Launches VLC with resume-where-you-left-off support
- **Steam Deck** Optimised touch targets, works in Game Mode via Steam

2 — Installation

Step 1 — Download from GitHub

Go to the Releases page on the GitHub repository and download both files from the latest release. Place them in the same folder (e.g. Downloads).

```
Firefly-Media-Library-linux-x64.zip  
install.sh
```

Step 2 — Run the installer (Desktop Mode)

Switch your Steam Deck to Desktop Mode (Steam button → Power → Switch to Desktop), open Konsole (terminal), and run:

```
cd ~/Downloads  
bash install.sh
```

The installer will automatically:

- Install VLC via Flatpak if not already present

- Extract the app to `~/firefly-media-library/`
- Create a desktop shortcut
- Create `steam-launch.sh` for adding to Steam

Step 3 — Add to Steam

1. Open Steam in Desktop Mode
2. Click Games → Add a Non-Steam Game to My Library
3. Click Browse and navigate to: `/home/deck/firefly-media-library/steam-launch.sh`
4. Click Add Selected Programs
5. Right-click the entry in your library → Properties
6. Rename it to Firefly Media Library
7. In Launch Options add: `--no-sandbox --disable-gpu-sandbox`
8. Under Controller, set the layout to Web Browser

■ *The Controller layout must be set to Web Browser for touch and trackpad to work correctly in Game Mode.*

3 — First Launch & Settings

On first launch you will see the loading screen briefly while the app scans your configured library folders. If no folders are configured yet, the library will be empty. Tap the  Settings button in the top-right to configure your paths.

Settings Fields

Field	Description
Movie Library Folders	One or more folders containing your movie files
TV Show Library Folders	One or more folders containing your TV show files
Video Library Folders	Folders for home videos, concerts, recordings, etc.
VLC Player Path	Path to the VLC executable (auto-detected on install)
TMDB API Key	Optional — enables automatic artwork and metadata fetching

Common Deck Paths

```
# Internal storage
/home/deck/Movies
/home/deck/TV Shows
/home/deck/Videos

# SD card (check exact name in Dolphin file manager)
/run/media/mmcblk0p1/Movies
/run/media/mmcblk0p1/TV Shows
```

You can add multiple folders per library type. Click Browse to navigate visually, or paste a path directly and click Add. Click  Save & Refresh Library when done — the app will rescan all folders.

4 — Media File Structure

Firefly scans your library folders and builds the library from the folder structure and any artwork/NFO files it finds alongside your media. The recommended structure below ensures the best results.

Movies

Each movie should be in its own named folder. The folder name is used as the title if no NFO file is present. Include the year in brackets for best matching.

```
Movies/  
The Dark Knight (2008)/  
The Dark Knight (2008).mkv  
poster.jpg ← movie poster  
fanart.jpg ← background/fanart image  
movie.nfo ← optional metadata file  
  
Inception (2010)/  
Inception (2010).mkv  
poster.jpg  
fanart.jpg
```

TV Shows

TV shows use a Show → Season → Episode hierarchy. Season folders should be named "Season 1", "Season 2" etc. Episodes should include SxxExx in the filename.

```
TV Shows/  
Breaking Bad/  
poster.jpg ← show poster  
fanart.jpg ← show background  
tvshow.nfo ← optional show metadata  
season01-poster.jpg ← optional season artwork  
Season 1/  
S01E01 - Pilot.mkv  
S01E01 - Pilot.nfo  
S01E01 - Pilot-thumb.jpg ← episode thumbnail  
S01E02 - Cats in the Bag.mkv  
Season 2/  
S02E01 - Seven Thirty-Seven.mkv
```

Videos

The Videos section uses your folder structure as categories. Top-level subfolders become the browseable folder cards. Nesting is fully supported — deeper folders are shown as subcategories inside each card.

```

Videos/
Concerts/
Radiohead Live 2023.mkv
Radiohead Live 2023.jpg ← thumbnail (same filename)
Daft Punk Alive.mkv
Home Videos/
2023/
Holiday.mp4
Birthday.mp4
2024/
Summer Trip.mp4
Sports/
Cup Final 2024.mkv

```

Supported Video Formats

Firefly recognises the following file extensions:

```

.mkv .mp4 .avi .mov .m4v .wmv .flv .ts .m2ts .webm .mpg .mpeg .m2v .divx
.xvid .ogv .ogm .vob .iso .rmvb .rm .asf .f4v .3gp .3g2 .mxf .mts .dv .qt
.amv .nsv

```

Artwork File Names

Firefly looks for artwork files in the same folder as your media. The following filenames are recognised automatically:

Artwork Type	Recognised Filenames
Poster / Cover	poster.jpg • folder.jpg • cover.jpg • movie.jpg • *-poster.jpg
Fanart / Background	fanart.jpg • backdrop.jpg • background.jpg • *-fanart.jpg
Season Poster	season01-poster.jpg • season02-poster.jpg • (etc.)
Episode Thumb	S01E01-thumb.jpg • S01E01.jpg (same stem as video file)

5 — Getting Artwork with Scrapers

Scrapers are tools that automatically download posters, fanart, metadata, and episode information from online databases and save them alongside your media files in the exact format Firefly expects. This is the easiest way to get a fully illustrated library without manually sourcing images.

Option A — Kodi Media Scraper (Recommended)

Kodi is a free, open-source media player that includes powerful library scraping. You can point Kodi at your media folders, let it scrape all artwork and metadata, then use Firefly to play the same files. Kodi writes standard .nfo files and saves artwork with the exact filenames Firefly looks for.

Setup steps:

1. Install Kodi on your PC or Steam Deck (free at kodi.tv)
2. Open Kodi → Settings → Media → Library
3. Add your Movies folder as a Movie source, set scraper to "The Movie Database"
4. Add your TV Shows folder as a TV source, set scraper to "TheTVDB" or "TMDB"
5. Let Kodi scan and download all artwork (this can take a while for large libraries)
6. Kodi saves poster.jpg, fanart.jpg, and .nfo files directly in each media folder
7. Launch Firefly — it will automatically read the artwork Kodi created

✓ *Kodi and Firefly can coexist — they read the same files without conflict.*

Option B — Jellyfin / Emby Scraper

Jellyfin is a free self-hosted media server that also scrapes artwork and writes NFO files. If you already run Jellyfin for remote streaming, it will have already downloaded artwork that Firefly can use.

1. Install Jellyfin Server on your PC (jellyfin.org)
2. Add your media folders as libraries in the Jellyfin dashboard
3. Set the metadata provider to TMDB (built in)
4. Run a library scan — Jellyfin downloads and saves artwork locally
5. Enable "Save artwork into media folders" in Jellyfin library settings
6. Firefly will read the artwork files automatically

Option C — tinyMediaManager (TMM)

tinyMediaManager is a dedicated media management tool designed specifically for building Kodi-compatible libraries. It gives fine-grained control over exactly which artwork gets downloaded and where it is saved.

Key features:

- Downloads poster, fanart, banner, clearlogo, disc art per movie/show
- Renames files to match your preferred naming convention
- Writes NFO files with full metadata (cast, director, plot, ratings)
- Batch scraping — process hundreds of titles at once
- Available at: tinymediamanager.org (free community edition)

Option D — TMDB API Key in Firefly Settings

Firefly has built-in TMDB support. Adding a free API key in Settings enables Firefly to fetch metadata at scan time for any title that does not already have an NFO file. This is the lightest-weight option but does not download artwork files — metadata is fetched live and not saved to disk.

Getting a free TMDB API key:

1. Go to themoviedb.org and create a free account
2. Click your profile icon → Settings → API
3. Click "Create" under API Key (Developer)
4. Fill in the short application form (personal use is fine)
5. Copy your API Read Access Token (v4 auth)
6. Open Firefly Settings → paste the key in the TMDB API Key field
7. Click Save & Refresh Library

■ *The TMDB API key requires an internet connection at scan time. Artwork downloaded via scrapers (Kodi, TMM) works fully offline.*

6 — Using the Library

Home Screen

The home screen shows a rotating hero banner of your recently added movies, followed by horizontal scrolling rows for Movies, TV Shows, Videos, and Collections. Swipe or scroll left/right within each row. Tap any card to open its detail view.

Tab	Description
Home	Hero banner + recent content rows
Movies	Full movie grid with genre filter chips
TV Shows	Full TV grid with genre filter chips
Videos	Folder-card grid — tap a folder to see its contents
Genres	All genres as horizontal scrolling rows
Collections	Auto-detected collection groups

Movie Detail View

Tap any movie card to open its detail view. This shows the full poster, title, year, genre, rating, runtime, director, and plot. Two action buttons are shown at the top:

-  Play — launches VLC immediately
-  Resume (Xm) — appears if you previously watched part of the film, resumes from where you left off

TV Show Detail View

Tap any TV show card to open the show detail view. All seasons are listed with episode counts. Expand any season to see the episode list — each row shows the episode thumbnail, S01E01 code, episode title, and a play button. Tap any episode row to play it immediately.

Genre Filter Bar

On the Movies and TV Shows pages, a row of genre chips appears at the top. Tap any chip to filter the grid to that genre only. Genres are listed in standard TMDb order (Action, Adventure, Animation...). Tap All to clear the filter.

7 — Videos Section

The Videos section works differently from Movies and TV. Instead of a flat grid, your top-level subfolders are shown as folder cards — similar to how TV shows appear. Each card shows the folder name, number of videos, and the first thumbnail found.

Browsing Videos

- The Videos page shows one card per top-level subfolder in your video paths
- Tap a folder card to open its contents as a scrollable list
- Videos are listed alphabetically with numbering
- If a video is in a deeper subfolder, the subfolder path is shown next to the title
- Tap any video row to play it immediately in VLC
- In-progress videos show a small orange progress bar below the title

Folder Thumbnails

Firefly uses the first image file it finds in the folder as the folder card artwork. To set a specific thumbnail for a folder, place an image with the same filename as any video file in that folder:

```
Videos/Concerts/  
Radiohead Live 2023.mkv  
Radiohead Live 2023.jpg ← used as folder art
```

Home Page Videos Row

The most recently added videos also appear as individual cards in the "Videos" row on the Home page, sorted by date added. Tapping these plays the video directly without opening the folder view.

8 — Search & Genres

Search

Tap the  search icon in the top-right navigation bar to open the search field. Type any part of a title — results update as you type across Movies, TV Shows, and Videos simultaneously. Tap any result card to open it.

Press Escape or tap the search icon again to close search and return to your previous page.

Genres Page

The Genres tab shows every genre present in your library as a horizontal scrolling row — the same style as the Home page. Movies and TV shows are combined within each genre row, with movies shown first then TV shows, both sorted alphabetically.

Genres are ordered using the standard TMDb genre list (Action → Adventure → Animation → Comedy...). Any genres found in your NFO files that are not in the TMDb list are appended alphabetically at the end.

Common alternate spellings are normalised automatically — for example "Sci-Fi", "Science-Fiction", and "SciFi" all map to the canonical TMDb name "Science Fiction".

9 — Collections

Collections are automatically detected when any part of a movie's folder path contains the word "collection" (case-insensitive). Movies in the same collection folder are grouped together.

Example folder structure:

```
Movies/  
Marvel Collection/  
Iron Man (2008)/  
Iron Man (2008).mkv  
The Avengers (2012)/  
The Avengers (2012).mkv  
Iron Man 2 (2010)/  
Iron Man 2 (2010).mkv  
  
The Godfather Collection/  
The Godfather (1972)/  
The Godfather Part II (1974)/
```

This would create two collections: "Marvel" and "The Godfather". The Collections tab in the nav bar only appears when at least one collection is detected. Movies within collections are sorted by year.

10 — Playback, Resume & Sleep

Playing Media

All media plays through VLC. When you tap Play, Firefly launches VLC in fullscreen mode and minimises itself. A "Now Playing" bar appears at the bottom-right of the Firefly interface showing the current title.

To stop playback and return to Firefly, tap the ■ Stop button in the Now Playing bar, or press Escape on a keyboard.

Resume Watching

Firefly tracks your watch position automatically. When VLC closes after you have watched more than 30 seconds, your position is saved. The next time you open that movie's detail view a "■ Resume (Xm)" button will appear showing your saved position.

Continue Watching Row

Any in-progress movies appear in the "Continue Watching" row at the top of the Home page, sorted by most recently watched.

Sleep / Wake Protection

Firefly prevents the Steam Deck from sleeping while VLC is playing. If you put the Deck to sleep manually during playback, VLC is stopped cleanly and your position is saved automatically before the system suspends.

11 — Troubleshooting

App crashes on launch from Steam

- Right-click the game in Steam → Properties → Launch Options
- Ensure `--no-sandbox --disable-gpu-sandbox` is present
- Ensure Controller layout is set to Web Browser
- Try removing and re-adding the game to Steam

Stuck on loading / scanning screen

- Open Konsole and run: `~/firefly-media-library/steam-launch.sh`
- Any error message will be printed to the terminal
- Check that your media folder paths exist and are accessible
- SD card paths change if the card is reinserted — re-add the path in Settings

No artwork showing

- Check that `poster.jpg` or `folder.jpg` exists in the movie folder
- Image must be a `.jpg`, `.jpeg`, `.png`, or `.webp` file
- Use a scraper tool (Kodi, TMM) to download artwork automatically
- Or add a TMDb API key in Settings for live metadata fetching

VLC not launching

- Open Settings and check the VLC Path field
- For Flatpak VLC: `flatpak run org.videolan.VLC`
- For system VLC: `/usr/bin/vlc`
- Run `bash install.sh` again to auto-detect VLC

TV show episodes not appearing

- Season folders must be named "Season 1", "Season 2" etc.
- Episode files must contain `SxxExx` (e.g. `S01E03`) in the filename
- Check that episodes are inside a season subfolder, not loose in the show folder

Genres page is empty

- Genres are read from .nfo files or the TMDB API
- Without either, the genre field will be blank
- Use a scraper to write NFO files with genre metadata
- Or add a TMDB API key in Settings

Updating the app

- Download the new zip and install.sh from GitHub Releases
- Run `bash install.sh` — it overwrites the app but preserves settings
- Settings are stored in `~/.config/sdml/config.json`
- Watch history is stored in `~/.local/share/sdml/playback.json`

For further help, visit the [GitHub repository Issues page](#).